

Collects and Biographies for

Saints' Days & Festivals

of the Scottish Episcopal Calendar

September

Using this booklet

This booklet contains a short biography, and appropriate collects, for all saints and dated festivals within the Scottish Calendar published in 1996. It does not provide Post-Communion Prayers.

You may use the short biography as a preface to the Collect of the Day to introduce the life of the saint to the congregation, or as a short homily.

This booklet is arranged with one saint (or festival) to a page, giving details of the saint's day, its category (1-6) and the liturgical colour. Collects for use at a 1970 Scottish Liturgy (or 1929) Eucharist are given on the left, those for 1982 Scottish Liturgy on the right.

Notes

- Where feasts in Category 4 fall on a Sunday (other than a Sunday in Categories 1 and 2), they may, if local circumstances require, be kept on that day.
- When days in Category 6 coincide with a day of higher category, they should be omitted that year.

Key to Abbreviations

1928	The Prayer Book as proposed in 1928 (C of E)
CCP	Celebrating Common Prayer (Society of St Francis)
DSB	A Diocesan Service Book (L.S. Hunter; OUP, 1965)
ECUSA	Episcopal Church of the United States of America
F	Black Letter Saints' Days (W.H. Frere; SPCK, 1961)
LFF	The proper for the Lesser Feasts and Fasts, 1991 (ECUSA)
MEG	Malcolm E. Grant, The Revd. Canon
R	The Roman Missal (1970)
SEC	Scottish Episcopal Church Alternative Collects
SPB	Scottish Prayer Book 1929, as amended in 1967

Credits

Originally compiled by the Reverend Canon Malcolm E Grant, and used at the Cathedral of St Andrew, Inverness. This version was edited and repaginated by the Reverend Gareth J M Saunders, Edinburgh, June–October 2003. Additional material was taken from *Exciting Holiness*, Second Edition, 2003.

Version 2.2

2 SEPTEMBER

The Martyrs of Papua New Guinea (1942) [6] *Red*

Christian missionary work began in Papua New Guinea in the 1860s, and was confronted with many difficulties because of the difficult terrain and the cultural diversity of the people. Nearly 300 Christian men and women died for their faith in Papua New Guinea during the Japanese Occupation in the Second World War, among them 12 Anglicans.

When Papua New Guinea was invaded most Church workers decided to remain at their posts, despite the risks. In a broadcast Bishop Philip Strong urged them that “missionaries do not think of themselves in the hour of danger and crisis, but of the Master who called them to give their all, and of the people whom He trusts them to serve and to love to the uttermost.”

Of those who died, the best known is Fr. Vivian Redlich, who was beheaded on the beach at Buna, together with two other priests, a nurse, a teacher, and a Papuan evangelist, in 1942.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
by who grace
the Martyrs of New Guinea
were enabled to bear witness
to thine only-begotten Son
by thinking not of themselves
but of those
whom they were sent to serve,
and by laying down their lives
for their Master:
grant us a like faith,
and the courage to profess it
in all adversities;
through the same Jesus Christ our
Lord.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

All-powerful and ever-living God,
turn our weakness into strength.
As you gave the martyrs
of Papua New Guinea
the courage to suffer death
for Christ,
give us the courage
to live in faithful witness to you;
through the same
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(Unknown)

3 SEPTEMBER

Gregory the Great, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith (604) [6] *White*

Born at Rome around AD 540, of a patrician family, Gregory entered public service and became Prefect of the City. At about 35 he entered a monastery, then served for 6 years as papal legate to Constantinople. In AD 590 he was elected Pope, the first monk to be called to that office, and at a time of great disorder, showed himself an able administrator and statesman, a true pastor, notable for his care of the poor and prisoners, and a remarkable teacher, accounted the 4th of the great Latin Doctors of the Church.

The sight of Anglo-Saxon youths exposed for sale in the Roman slave-market prompted him to send missionaries to England under the leadership of Augustine. Almost every aspect of Church life benefited from Gregory's ministry, but he is particularly remembered for his ordering of the Church's liturgy and its music, which shaped the spirituality of the Western Church through the Middle Ages. He died in the year 604.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
who didst call Saint Gregory
to the office of a bishop,
that he might rule in thy Church
with pastoral care:
grant that after his example
we may burn with a love of souls,
and labour that the praises of Jesus
may be sung in every land;
though the same
thy Son Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Merciful Father,
you chose your bishop Gregory
to be a servant
of the servants of God:
grant that, like him,
we may ever long to serve you
by proclaiming your gospel
to the nations,
and ever rejoice to sing your praises;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.
(CCP)

8 SEPTEMBER

The Birth of Mary, Mother of the Lord [5] *White*

"The mother of Jesus was a Jewish maiden, called Miriam in Hebrew, traditionally of the family of King David; nothing sure is known about her parentage or the place of her birth." (p.235)

The tradition that Mary's parents were Joachim and Anna, derives "from an early apocryphal writing called the 'Protevangelium of James', which professes to give an account of Mary's coming into the world (and other things besides). This story bears a strong resemblance to the biblical narrative (1 Samuel 1) of the childless Hannah's bearing of Samuel." (p.186)

In the Roman Catholic church it is an article of faith that God preserved Mary from the taint of 'original sin' from the first moment of her conception in her mother's womb (her 'immaculate conception')." (p.235)

(from The Penguin Dictionary of Saints, 1965)

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O merciful God,
hear the prayers of thy servants
who commemorate the Nativity
of the Mother of the Lord;
and grant that by the incarnation
of thy dear Son
we may indeed
be made nigh unto him;
who liveth and reigneth with thee
and the Holy Ghost,
one God, world without end.

(1928)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
who stooped to raise fallen humanity
through the child-bearing
of blessed Mary:
grant that we
who have seen your glory
revealed in our human nature,
and your love
made perfect in our weakness
may daily be renewed
in your image,
and conformed
to the pattern of your Son,
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

13 SEPTEMBER

Cyprian of Carthage, Bishop and Martyr (258) [6] *Red*

Cyprian, born in Tunisia around the year AD 200, was a lawyer and teacher of rhetoric at Carthage. At about 46 he became a Christian, and two years later was made Bishop of Carthage. Persecution broke out within a year, and Cyprian went into hiding, for which he was much criticized, and in his last years he was involved in controversy over the re-admission to the Church of those who had followed the rigorist and heretical sects of North Africa.

Cyprian was loved for his goodness, his care for the poor, and his concern never to make decisions without consulting his clergy. He wrote an important treatise on the unity of the Church. When persecution broke out again in 258, Cyprian was one of the first victims, beheaded for refusing to sacrifice to the Roman gods.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who didst give
to thy servant Cyprian
boldness to confess the Name
of our Saviour Jesus Christ
before the rulers of this world,
and courage to die for this faith:
grant that we may always be ready
to give a reason for the hope
that is in us,
and to suffer gladly for the sake
of the same our Lord Jesus Christ;
who liveth and reigneth with thee
and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(ECUSA – LFF)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,
through your servant Cyprian
you have taught us
that the Church is our mother
and that all forgiveness
comes from you:
keep us steadfast
in the faith of the Church,
so that, turning to Christ,
we may come to share
in the heavenly banquet
which you have prepared for us;
through your Son,
Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

14 SEPTEMBER

Holy Cross Day [6] *White*

The origin of this festival is in the commemoration of the basilica of the Holy Sepulchre, erected by the emperor Constantine in Jerusalem on the site of the empty tomb, close by the Hill of Calvary. The dedication of this great church took place in the year AD 335, on September 14, a date suggested by the date of the dedication of Solomon's Temple in Jerusalem, and within which the basilica was set up as an object of devotion to the relic, discovered by the emperor's mother, Helena, believed to be the actual cross on which Jesus suffered. Since then, the festival has been seen also – and now, principally – as a celebration of the triumph of the Cross, and a reminder to Christians that the essence of their discipleship is to express the reality of the Cross in daily living.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
whose Son our Saviour Jesus Christ
was lifted high upon the Cross
that he might draw the whole world
unto himself:
mercifully grant that we,
who glory in the mystery
of our redemption,
may have grace to take up our cross
and follow him;
who liveth and reigneth with thee
and the Holy Spirit,
one God, in glory everlasting.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who in the passion
of your blessed Son
made an instrument of painful death
to be for us
the means of life and peace:
grant us so to glory
in the cross of Christ
that we may gladly suffer
for his sake;
who is alive and reigns with you
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SEC)

16 SEPTEMBER

Ninian of Whithorn, Bishop (c.430) [4] *White*

Ninian is the first identified person in the story of the Church in Scotland. The son of a Romano-British chief in Galloway, around the time the Roman legions withdrew from Britain, he went to Rome to study for the priesthood.

On his return journey he spent some time with Saint Martin at Tours, and then established a missionary centre at Whithorn, in Galloway, his little stone-built church being known as “Candida Casa” or “the white house”.

His missionary efforts extended far into Scotland and across the Irish Sea, although the collapse of social structures after the Roman withdrawal probably meant that much of his success was short-lived. He died in c. 430.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God, who by the preaching of
thy blessed servant Saint Ninian
didst cause the light of the Gospel
to shine in this our land:
Grant, we beseech thee that,
having his life and labours
in remembrance,
we may shew forth our thankfulness
unto thee for the same
by following the example
of his zeal and patience;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everlasting God,
who called your servant Ninian
to preach the Gospel
to the people of northern Britain:
raise up in this and every land
heralds and evangelists
of your kingdom,
that your Church may make known
the immeasurable riches
of your Son Jesus Christ,
who is alive and reigns with you,
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SEC)

17 SEPTEMBER

Hildegard of Bingen, Abbess (1179) [6] *White*

Hildegard, the 'Sibyl of the Rhine' was one of the most remarkable women of the Middle Ages. Born at Bermersheim in 1098, she was educated by a recluse, and entered a Benedictine convent, of which she became superior in 1136.

From an early age she claimed unusual spiritual and prophetic experiences. Around 1147 she removed her community to Rupertsberg, near Bingen, where she built a large convent, from which she promulgated her revelations and oracles. In troubled times she corresponded at length with popes, kings and emperors as well as with leading churchmen. Her writings include expositions of the Gospels and the Rule of Saint Benedict, as well as scientific treatises, poems, hymns and music. She died in 1179.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
whose Holy Spirit bestows
upon each his gifts
according to thy sovereign will:
we praise thee for the gifts
of thy grace manifested
in thy servant Hildegard,
and we pray
that in the power of the same Spirit
thou wilt raise up in our generation
leaders for thy Church with vision,
wisdom and understanding,
who will proclaim thy word
with boldness
and draw many
into the ways of righteousness;
through Jesus Christ our Lord,
who with thee and the same Spirit
liveth and reigneth, one God,
for ever and ever.

(MEG)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
your Spirit bestows on each his gifts
according to your sovereign will:
we praise you for the gifts
of your grace manifested
in your servant Hildegard,
and we pray
you will raise up in our generation
leaders for your Church
with vision, wisdom and
understanding,
who will proclaim your word
with boldness
and draw many
into the ways of righteousness;
through Jesus Christ our Lord,
lives and reigns with you
and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(MEG)

20 SEPTEMBER

John Coleridge Patteson, Bishop and Martyr (1871) [6] *Red*

Educated at Eton, where came under the influence of George Selwyn, later the first Bishop of New Zealand, in 1855, two years after his ordination, Patteson set out for the South Seas, to found the Melanesian Mission. He toured many of the islands in his ship "Southern Cross", learned many of the native languages, and had considerable pastoral and educational success. He was consecrated the first Bishop of Melanesia in 1861. In 1871 he and several of his companions were murdered on the island of Nukapu, in revenge for the kidnapping of some of the inhabitants by white slave-traders some months earlier.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Holy and merciful Father,
whose will it is that all should be
saved and come to the knowledge
of thy truth:
we praise thee for the witness
of thy servant John Coleridge
Patteson, testifying in life and death
to thy love made known in Jesus
Christ; and we pray that the work
which in thy providence he began
may by thy Holy Spirit be brought to
its fruition to thy honour and glory;
through the same thy Son Jesus
Christ our Lord, who with thee
and the same Holy Spirit liveth and
reigneth, one God, for ever and ever.
(DSB – adapted)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

God our Father,
your loving purpose
is that all people should be saved
and come to the knowledge of your
truth:
we give thanks for the witness
of John Coleridge Patteson,
testifying in life and death
to your love made known
in Jesus Christ;
and we pray that the work
which in your providence he began
may by your Holy Spirit
be brought to its fruition
to your honour and glory;
through the same Jesus Christ our
Lord, who lives and reigns with you
and the same Holy Spirit one God,
for ever and ever.
(DSB – adapted)

21 SEPTEMBER

Matthew, Apostle and Evangelist [4] *Red*

Matthew, a tax-collector, was called by Jesus to follow Him from his seat in the custom-house. Tax-collectors were regarded as collaborators with Rome and traitors to their own people, and the Roman system for raising taxation meant that their livelihood had to be secured by imposing additional revenues on their own people. In addition, the religious establishment spurned them because of their contact with Gentiles.

Whether Matthew wrote the Gospel that bears his name in the form in which we now know it is widely doubted today, but it is probable that the apostle, a man accustomed to keeping records, compiled a collection of the teaching of Jesus, which have been incorporated into the Gospel. Nothing is known of his subsequent career, but there is a strong tradition that he evangelized effectively among the Jews, and some ancient writers hint at his martyrdom, whether in Ethiopia or in Persian.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
who by thy blessed Son
didst call Matthew
from the receipt of custom
to be an Apostle and Evangelist:
Grant us grace to forsake
all covetous desires
and inordinate love of riches,
and to follow the same
thy Son Jesus Christ;
who liveth and reigneth with thee
and the Holy Ghost,
one God, world without end.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O Almighty God,
whose blessed Son
called Matthew the tax-collector
to be an apostle and evangelist:
give us grace to forsake
the selfish pursuit of gain
and the possessive love of riches
that we may follow in the way
of your Son Jesus Christ,
who is alive and reigns with you,
in the unity of the Holy Spirit,
one God, now and for ever.

(SEC)

23 SEPTEMBER
Adamnan of Iona, Abbot (704) [6] *White*

Adamnan (or Eunan), the 9th Abbot of Iona, was born at Donegal in about AD 624, and was directly related to Saint Columba, whose Life he wrote. He became a monk, and was elected Abbot at the age of 55. He travelled widely, in evangelistic endeavours and on political missions.

In his travels he was won over by the Romanizing party in the Church, and tried to steer his community to follow these reforms, which they resisted strongly. He played a leading part in the Synod of Birr in 697, which enacted Adamnan's Law Code to raise the status of women, and it is possible that he remained in Ireland for the rest of his life, returning to Iona just before his death in AD 704.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O heavenly Father,
Shepherd of thy people,
we give thee thanks
for thy servant Adamnan,
who was faithful in the care
and nurture of thy flock;
and we pray that,
following his example
and the teaching of his holy life,
we may by thy grace
grow into the stature
of the fullness of our Lord
and Saviour Jesus Christ;
who liveth and reigneth with thee
and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Heavenly Father,
Shepherd of your people,
we thank you
for your servant Adamnan,
who was faithful in the care
and nurture of your flock;
and we pray that,
following his example
and the teaching of his holy life,
we may by your grace
grow into the stature
of the fullness of our Lord
and Saviour Jesus Christ;
who lives and reigns with you
and the Holy Spirit,
one God, for ever and ever.

(ECUSA)

25 SEPTEMBER

Finnbar of Caithness, Bishop (c.610) [6] *White*

Probably a native of Connacht, he was active in Munster and is venerated as the founder of the monastery and see of Cork. He is said to have visited South Wales, and his name is associated with Saint David. He is also reputed to have come to Scotland in the course of his missionary journeys, early in the 7th century, and founded a monastery at Dornoch. According to the Aberdeen Martyrdom, he died in Caithness.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who willest to be glorified
in thy saints,
and didst raise up
thy servant Finnbar
to be a light in the world:
shine, we pray thee, in our hearts,
that we also in our generation
may show forth thy praise,
who hast called us out of darkness
into thy marvellous light;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ECUSA)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty God,
who will it is to be glorified
in your saints,
you raised up your servant Finnbar
to be a light in the world:
shine, we pray, in our hearts,
that we also in our generation
may show forth your praise,
who called us out of darkness
into your marvellous light;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(ECUSA)

27 SEPTEMBER
Vincent de Paul, Priest (1660) [6] *White*

Born in Gascony in 1581, the son of a peasant farmer, he was ordained priest at the early age of 20. Some years' ministry among neglected peasants and convicts in the hulks changed his whole outlook on life, and he dedicated himself to the service of the poor. Groups of lay people were organized for charitable work, and in 1625 in Paris, he founded the Congregation of the Mission (Vincentians) for the spiritual formation of the clergy and the relief of the poor. In 1633, with the help of Saint Louise de Marillac, he found the Sisters of Charity, who now work all over the world.

He approached every situation with humility and a simple trust in God's providence, and his single-minded goodness and generosity stirred a like generosity in others. His sensitivity to others is revealed, not least in his instructions to his missionaries on dealing with Protestants, who were to be treated as brothers, with respect and love. He died in Paris on this day in 1660.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O God, the Father of all,
we give thee thanks
for the life of your servant
Vincent de Paul,
and for his ministry of preaching
and of caring for the poor:
help us, we pray thee,
to follow his example,
and by our words and actions
to make known thy love
known to others in their need;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

O God,
as we thank you for the life
of your servant Vincent de Paul,
and for his ministry of preaching
and caring for the poor,
help us to follow his example,
and by our words and actions to
make your love
known to others in their need;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(CCP)

29 SEPTEMBER

Michael and All Angels [4] *White*

Michael, Gabriel and Raphael are the three named biblical angels, depicted as the beloved messengers of God. Michael, which means ‘who is like God?’ is described as the protector of Israel and leader of the armies of God and is perhaps best known for his victory over the dragon, which is told in the Revelation to John. In the East he was looked on as special guardian of the sick: outside Constantinople there was a church bearing his name from the time of Constantine.

Gabriel, which means ‘the strength of God’, is the one who, in the Gospel according to Luke, is sent by God to Mary to announce the birth of Christ. Raphael, which means ‘the healing of God’, is depicted in the Book of Tobit as the one who restores sight to Tobit’s eyes.

The festival of Michael the Archangel on this date originated in the annual commemoration of the dedication, in the fifth century, of a church in his honour near Rome.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Everlasting God,
who hast ordained and constituted
the services of angels and men
in a wonderful order:
Mercifully grant that,
as thy holy angels
always do thee service in heaven,
so by thy appointment
they may succour and defend us
on earth;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SPB)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Everlasting God,
you have ordained and constituted
the ministries of angels and mortals
in a wonderful order:
grant that, as your holy angels
always serve you in heaven,
so at your command,
they may help and defend us
on earth;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(SEC)

30 SEPTEMBER

Jerome, Priest and Teacher of the Faith (420) [6] *White*

Born at Strido in Dalmatia around AD 340, Jerome was brought up a Christian, but not baptized until adulthood. He studied in Rome, and then spent some years among the desert hermits of Syria, where he learned Hebrew from a rabbi, and although ordained priest he never exercised his priestly office.

In 382 he became secretary to Pope Damasus, at whose direction he revised the translation of the Latin New Testament, which began his most important work, the preparation of the “Vulgate” Latin Bible.

After the death of Pope Damasus he returned to the East and settled in Bethlehem, where he established a religious community with a hospice for travellers and a free school.

His penetrating intellect, combined with a rigorist spirit and an irascible nature, brought him into frequent controversy, in the course of which he wrote many letters and polemical treatises. He was the most learned of the Latin Fathers of the Church, and among the greatest of Biblical scholars. He died on this day in the year 420 at Bethlehem.

1970 Scottish Liturgy

O Lord,
who hast given us thy holy word
for a light to shine upon
the path of life:
grant us after the example
of thy servant Jerome
so to meditate upon the law
and rule ourselves
according to thy word,
that we may find in it
the light that shineth
more and more unto the perfect day;
through Jesus Christ our Lord.

(F)

1982 Scottish Liturgy

Almighty and everliving God,
you endowed Saint Jerome
with a deep reverence
for Holy Scripture
and a delight in its study:
sustain us evermore
with your holy Word,
and help us to find in it
the food of salvation
and fountain of life;
through Jesus Christ
your living Word, our Saviour,
who reigns in glory with you
and the Holy Spirit,
God for ever and ever.

(MEG from R.)

September

1	—	—	—
2	The Martyrs of New Guinea, 1942	6	Red
3	Gregory the Great, Bishop and Teacher of the Faith	6	White
4	—	—	—
5	—	—	—
6	—	—	—
7	—	—	—
8	The Birth of Mary, Mother of the Lord	5	White
9	—	—	—
10	—	—	—
11	—	—	—
12	—	—	—
13	Cyprian of Carthage, Bishop and Martyr, 258	6	Red
14	Holy Cross Day	5	White
15	—	—	—
16	Ninian of Whithorn, Bishop, c.430	4	White
17	Hildegard of Bingen, Abbess, 1179	6	White
18	—	—	—
19	—	—	—
20	John Coleridge Patteson, Bishop and Martyr, 1871	6	Red
21	Matthew, Apostle and Evangelist	4	Red
22	—	—	—
23	Adamnan of Iona, Abbot, 704	6	White
24	—	—	—
25	Finnbar of Caithness, Bishop, c.610	6	White
26	—	—	—
27	Vincent de Paul, Priest, 1660	6	White
28	—	—	—
29	Michael and All Angels	4	White
30	Jerome, Priest and Teacher of the Faith, 420	6	White